



Rising Stars Atlanta 7v7 Series Rules

Team Registration: All team must be registered online to participate in the series. Any team or player discovered to falsified age will be dismissed from participation in the event . Parents should carry proof of player age / Identification, incase required, i.e.: Photo ID, Driver's license, Birth certificate or any player pass.

Team Rosters: A maximum of 12 players is allowed on the team roster. There will be a maximum of 7 players and a minimum of 4 players on the field to start a game. Co-ed teams must always have a minimum of 2 female (Female goal keeper counts). If minimum # of players is not met at game start time, the game clock will start and a goal will be awarded for the opposing team for each minute that passes where the team does not have enough players. Roasters are completed at the online check-in. Players may play on only one team per age group. No changes or substitutions to rosters after online check- in are completed. NO EXCEPTIONS.

Kick-Off: The kick-off may go in any direction. Teams must be ready to kick off at game time or forfeit the game.

Forfeits: Forfeited games will result in 3 points. However, if the game has begun and a team must forfeit for any reason, the score on the field at the time of the forfeit will stand in the point system.

A game will be a forfeit if: (a) a scheduled team is not ready to play within 5 minutes of the scheduled time. The Referee may extend this time to 3 minutes if he/she feels circumstances should allow. (b) A team does not have the minimum number of players needed to participate.

A team forfeiting a game(s) during any one season will be subject to the following fines:

1st Forfeit - \$20.00

2nd Forfeit - \$35.00

3rd Forfeit – Termination of team participation from the season and loss of re-registration priority

Equipment: All field players must wear the same color team uniform (numbers are Not required). Shin Guard must be worn at all games. If two teams have similar colored team uniform, the HOME team must change to a different color. Goalkeepers must wear a different color uniform from both teams. The referee must approve medical equipment such as casts or braces.

Fouls: FIFA soccer rules apply to all infractions, including but not limited to – kicking, pushing, tripping, hand balls, etc...

Slide Tackling: `Slide tackling resulting in contact with any player(s) from the opposite team is not allowed (indirect free kick awarded). Players may slide tackle to stop/intercept a ball (no contact with opposite player (s)). Example: a player may slide to save a ball from going out-of-bounds.

Coaching Conflict: For coaches with multiple teams, Rising Stars Atlanta will not be responsible for any coaching conflicts. Parents are allowed represents as a team coach.

Game Duration: The game consists of two equal halves of 24-minute separated by a 2 minute halftime period. No timeouts!

Weather Policy: In case of adverse weather, RSA reserves the right to any of the following actions: Delay play for a period of time, reduce game times in order to catch up to schedule, finish games before inclement weather arrives, or reschedule or cancel games for a later date.

Corner Kicks: are direct and will be taken from the designated spots.

Penalty Kicks: PKs will be taken from the top of the arch or 12 yards from the goal. Only the goalkeeper is allowed in the penalty area. If shot does not reach the goal, it becomes a goal kick, No rebounds.

Fouls: Physical foul will be direct free kicks; all others are indirect, except Penalty Kicks.

Kick-ins: All are indirect and the ball will be a throw in into play from the sidelines.

Substitution: Substitution Method: "Flying substitution" (all players but the goalkeeper enter and leave as they please at the halfway line; goalkeeper substitutions can only be made when the ball is out of play and with a referee's consent). Substitution players must enter/exit within 3 yards of the midfield line by "tagging" in and out. Any player may change places with the goalkeeper, provided that the referee is informed before the change is made, and provided also that the change is made during a stoppage of the game. Substitute players are to remain in the player's bench area.

Goal Scoring: Goal may be scored only from a touch within a team's offensive half of the field. Offensive team is awarded with a direct kick. (Direct Kick info below) Defensive team is awarded with a goal kick. Teams will change direction at half time and alternate kickoff. Player has 6 seconds to put ball back into play.

Goal Kick (Dribble in): Player has 6 seconds to take the goal kick or dribble it in from the goal line. Offensive team will be awarded with a corner kick if a decision is not made in 6 sec. Five-yard rule is applied to goal kicks (dribble in option).

Dead Ball Situation Drop ball from the half field line. Goal Kicks: 6 seconds to take the goal kick or offensive team will be awarded with a corner kick. Defending players must stand at least five yards away from the ball. If the defensive player's goal is closer than five yards, the ball shall be played five yards from the goal box in line with the direction of play prior to the penalty.

Yellow/Red Cards: A player receiving a yellow card must Sit Out for 2 minutes and the team must play a man down. The opposing team will be given a "power play" advantage.

Any player receiving a red card will automatically be required to miss the next game. If a team is found to be playing the next game with a player that received a red card in the previous game, that team may be forced to forfeit that game and/or their next game (at the Rising Stars Atlanta discretion). Rising Stars Atlanta reserves the right to review any and all red card offenses and take further action upon the player, coach or trainer if the offense is deemed violent or abusive in any such manner.

Player Ejection (Red Card): Referees have the right to eject a player or coach from the game for continual disobedience or as a result of an incident that warrants sending off. The team may then continue with their remaining two, three or four players, however, if the player receiving the red card was on the field of play, the team must complete the entire game a player short.

Players or coaches that are red carded must leave the immediate playing area, including the fan and team areas. If the player delays or refuses to leave, the game will be forfeited in favor of opposing team (regardless of the score at the time of the incident). If player(s) is (are) issued red card(s) for fighting, player(s) will be ejected from the tournament and is (are) subject to removal from the facility for the duration of the event.

Players that receive two yellow cards in one game will result in a red card. (Please see red card rule). Any player accumulating three yellow cards during a tournament/series will automatically be suspended for their next game (no exceptions). Rising Stars Atlanta reserves the right to disqualify any team, player, coach, or spectator who strikes threatens, physically or verbally, any participant or spectator.

Primary Scoring Point System: Win =3 points, Loss =0 points, Tie =1 point, Game forfeit = 3 points.

Tie Breakers: #1) Head to Head, #2) Highest Goal Differential, #3) Fewest Goals Allowed, #4) Most Goals Scored, #5) Least amount negative points for red/yellow cards issued against #6) Penalty Kicks

Tie-Breaker Procedure Order:

- To determine preliminary winners and runners up, if necessary:
- Winner of head to head competition
- Highest goal differential (goals for minus goals against).
- Least total goals against.
- Most total goals for.
- Least number of negative points for yellow or red cards issued against team.
- Red Card = 3 negative points
- Yellow Card = 1 negative point
- Penalty Kicks for semi-finals and final games
- If still tied, best 3 penalty kicks by 3 players of each team.
- If still tied, alternate penalty kicks shall continue until first team misses.
- Only players on the field of play at the end of overtime may participate in taking of the penalty kicks.

Game Play: No Offside.

Teams that play a player not on the roster will be disqualified.

Co-ed teams must always have a minimum of 2 female on the field.

Each game will have one Referee, who will call fouls, keep time, and monitor substitutions.

Soccer Ball Sizes: U8 - U12 size 4 Ball, U13 - U19 size 5 Ball

Ball heading: U8-U12 is not allowed and U13 –U19 is allowed

Goal Size: 6.5' x 12'

Tied Finals or Semifinals: If necessary, time shall be extended at the end of each period to allow the taking of a penalty kick. In event of a tie (during playoff only), penalty kicks will be taken (no overtime). Winner will be decided by the best team out of the 5 kicks. If still tied after both teams have taken 5 kicks,

then additional players will take the kicks in a sudden death kick off. Only players that were on the field at the end of the game will be allowed to participate.

Hand Ball Clarification: Deliberate handling of the ball that denies a team of an obvious goal-scoring opportunity will result in the following: (1) A penalty kick (at the discretion of the referee) (2) A yellow or red card given to the player committing the hand ball (at the discretion of the referee).

SPORTSMANSHIP: Protests are not allowed. Players, coaches, and spectators are expected to always act in good sportsmanship. Abuse of the referees will not be tolerated. Any instance of such conduct will lead to Cautioned (Yellow Card), and or ejection of the responsible team from the event without refund.

Clock: The clock is continuous. The Referee may stop the clock if, in his/her opinion, there is a possible extended delay in the game (e.g. serious injury). The clock will not stop on minor injuries (e.g. player hit by ball). It is the Referee's discretion to decide between a minor injury and a serious injury.

Coach/Parent Ejection: Referees have the right to eject a coach or parent from any game for continual disobedience or because of an incident that warrants ejection. Coaches or parents who are ejected by the referee or tournament official must leave the field and area around the field before play will continue. If a coach or parent refuses to leave, the game will be forfeited in favor of the opposing team.